

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Polygon prepares for their big event!



Learning Outcome

Present advice on solving technical problems in a work context and appropriate for the interlocutor.

Can Do Statements

- I can give suggestions.
- I can talk about food.
- I can give opinions.

Ask your partner:

- What kind of food would be appropriate for a work event?
- What do you think of having music in a work-related event? Is it appropriate? Why or why not?





Let's Explore!

Would you like some **cheese with your wine***?

* "Wine and cheese" are two of life's greatest culinary pleasures. They are both often served at parties.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Miranda:** Okay, what about brainstorming ideas to make this party a smashing success?
- Peter:** In my humble opinion there's nothing people enjoy as much as superb food and good music. What kind of music do you suggest appeals to our audience? I'd say something folky.
- Renata:** I would disagree. If you ask me, middle-aged women like to celebrate their youth. Personally, I think they'd enjoy a hot 20-something male band.
- Miranda:** Good point. Why don't we go with "1WayToHeaven"?
- Renata:** Maybe we should do that. Okay, let's talk about food.
- Rocco:** How about a wine and dine? I also believe finger food would work well.
- Peter:** Mixed salads. I'm convinced all women at least pretend to love salad.
- Renata:** If you want a successful reception, serve something healthy beside something scrumptious. Like chocolate, and tropical fruit ...
- Miranda:** You hit it Renata! Where's a woman who wouldn't love a chocolate fondue?
- Rocco:** I'm sure the accompanying males wouldn't mind either. But don't you think that could nicely follow wine and cheese? Champagne would go well with dessert.
- Peter:** Anything goes with vegetables.
- Miranda:** We can have it all. A fantastic reception with the wine flowing! Too bad it's nearly a month away.



Let's Practice!

In my humble opinion*, this is what we need to do.

*"Your "opinion" of something is what you personally feel or think about it.

Instructions: Tick all the correct answers. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Which sentences are opinions?

_____ In my humble opinion there's nothing people enjoy as much as superb food.

_____ I'd say people want to listen to something folky.

_____ How about a wine and dine?

_____ Why don't we go with "1WayToHeaven"?

_____ Let's talk about food.

_____ I'm convinced all women love salad.

_____ I'm sure the males wouldn't mind.



Let's Practice!

We need to plan the party and I'm open to suggestions*.

*"open to suggestions": means that you are willing to consider other people's ideas or plans.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Write each word in the correct order. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. music / and / people / opinion, / . / In / food / good / humble / my / love

2. like / middle-aged / their / If / women / celebrate / youth / me, / you / ask / . / to

3. If / . / to / variety / music / you / food / a / need / a / and / we / successful / of / want / party, / offer

4. believe / would / food / well / I / finger / also / . / work /

5. / . / I'm / convinced / event / the / the / is / ideal / for / band



Extension Activity

Organize an office party!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- You are going to organize an office party for your firm.
- Write down a list of possible food and music you could have.
- Have a conversation with a partner and make a few suggestions. (*For example: Why don't we have some sparkling water?*)
- Support your suggestions with opinions. (*For example: I'm convinced sparkling water is better and cheaper than wine.*)

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about food and music.

☐
☐

I make suggestions.

☐
☐

I give opinions to support my suggestions.

☐
☐


Target Words

- **wine and dine** (expression): to entertain someone by giving them an expensive meal and wine
e.g. How about a wine and dine?
- **finger food** (expression): food to be eaten with the fingers
e.g. I think finger food would work well.
- **mixed salad** (noun): a salad consisting of mixed salad vegetables such as lettuce, tomato, cucumber, etc.
e.g. All women love mixed salad.
- **fondue** (noun): A meal that consists of liquid chocolate or hot oil in a container into which you put small pieces of food using a long fork
e.g. Who wouldn't love a chocolate fondue?
- **tropical fruit** (noun): fruit from the hottest parts of the world
e.g. We should serve some tropical fruit.
- **scrumptious** (adjective): delicious
e.g. We should serve something healthy beside something scrumptious.





Learning Points

Giving Suggestions

Sometimes you have an idea, a recommendation or plan that you think could work for your company. It is important to use proper language to offer those ideas for someone to consider. Here is some language you can use for giving suggestions.

- What about + noun / -ing?
- Why don't we + verb?
- Maybe we should + verb
- Let's + verb
- How about + noun / -ing?
- Don't you think + clause

Examples:

- **What about** coming up with some ideas for the party?
- **Let's** make a list and decide on the food.
- **How about** having wine for the party?
- **Don't you think** wine and cheese would work for the party?
- **How about** serving wine?

Giving Opinions

Conversations are far more interesting when people interact during the conversation. It is important to ask for others' opinions on a subject as well as giving your own. Here are some ways you can give opinions.

- In my humble opinion, + clause
- I'd say + clause
- clause + , if you ask me.
- Personally, + clause
- I also believe + clause
- I'm convinced (that) + clause
- If you + verb, + clause
- I'm sure (that) + clause

Examples:

- **In my humble opinion**, people love good food and music.
- **I'd say** some pop music would work.
- **I'm sure** most people wouldn't mind.
- **If you want** a successful party, we need to offer a variety of food and music.
- **Personally**, I prefer salad.
- **I'm convinced** the band is ideal for the event.

